



An Roinn Dlí agus Cirt,
Gnóthaí Baile agus Imirce
Department of Justice,
Home Affairs and Migration

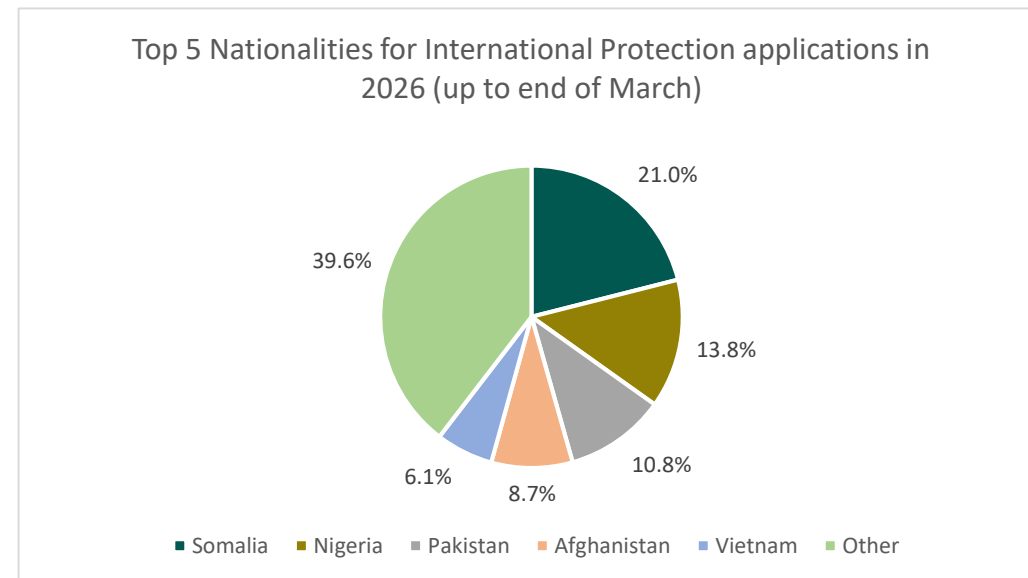
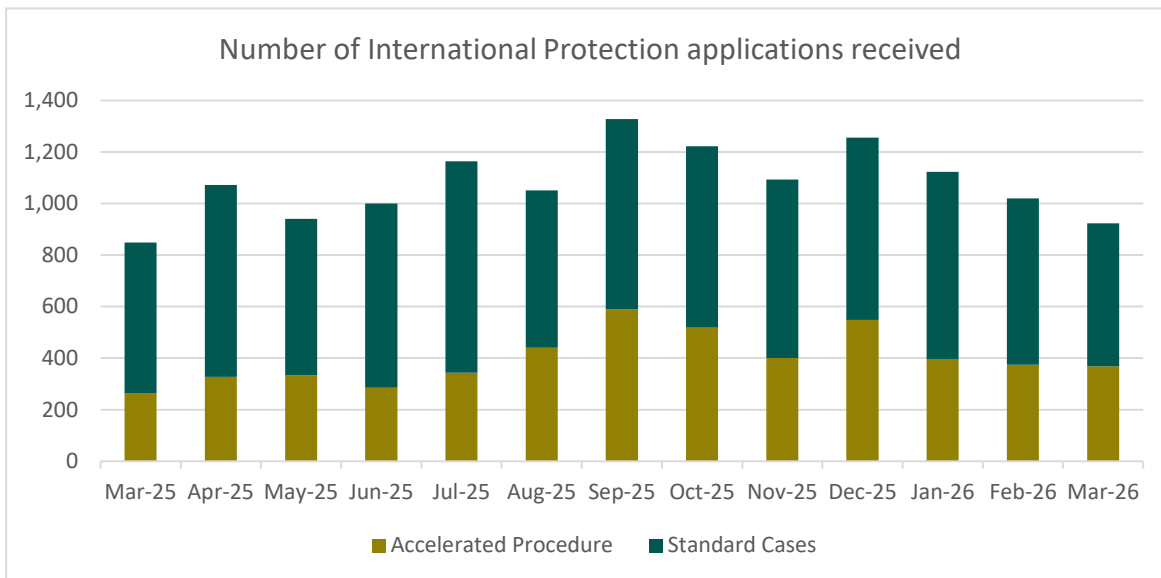
International Protection: March 2026

Executive Summary

The figures in this dashboard were extracted on the 8th April 2026. These are operational figures and subject to change. The charts below refer to key points in the asylum process. A flow chart is provided at the end of the pack that sets out this process. Overall, for March 2026:

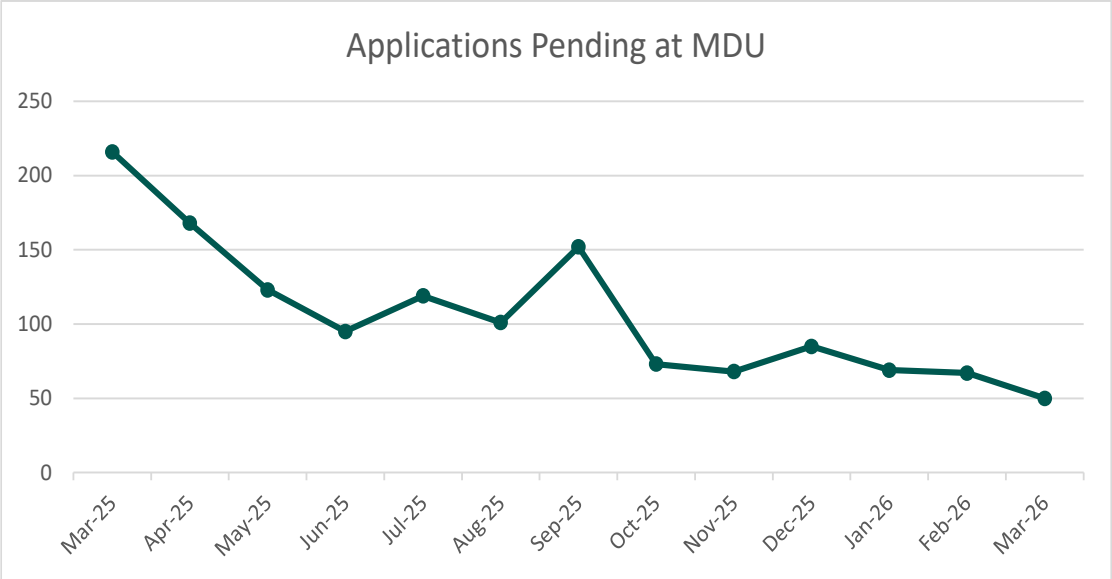
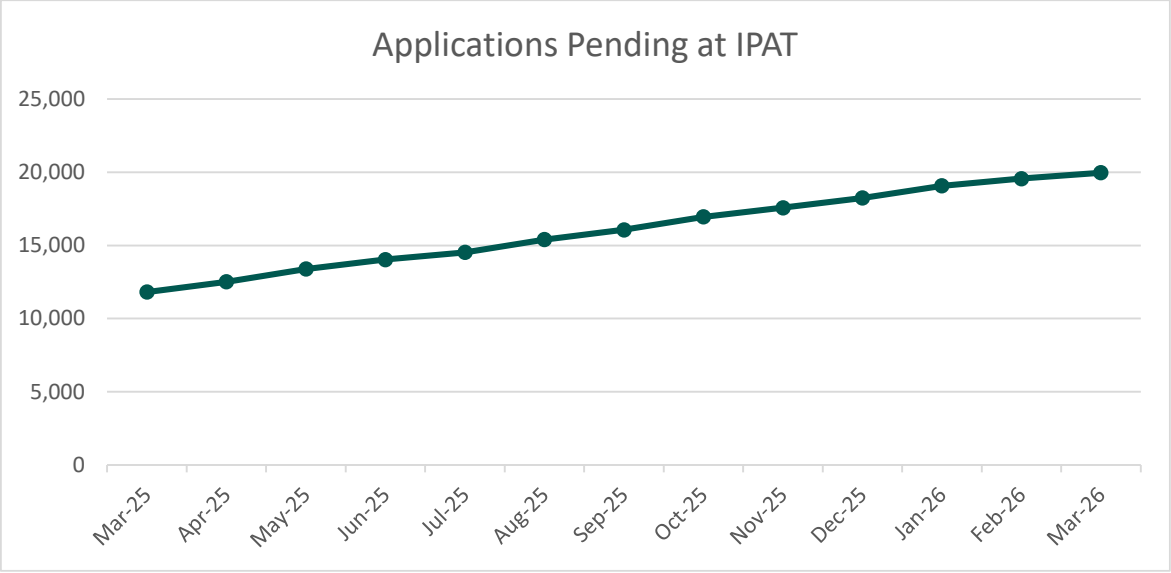
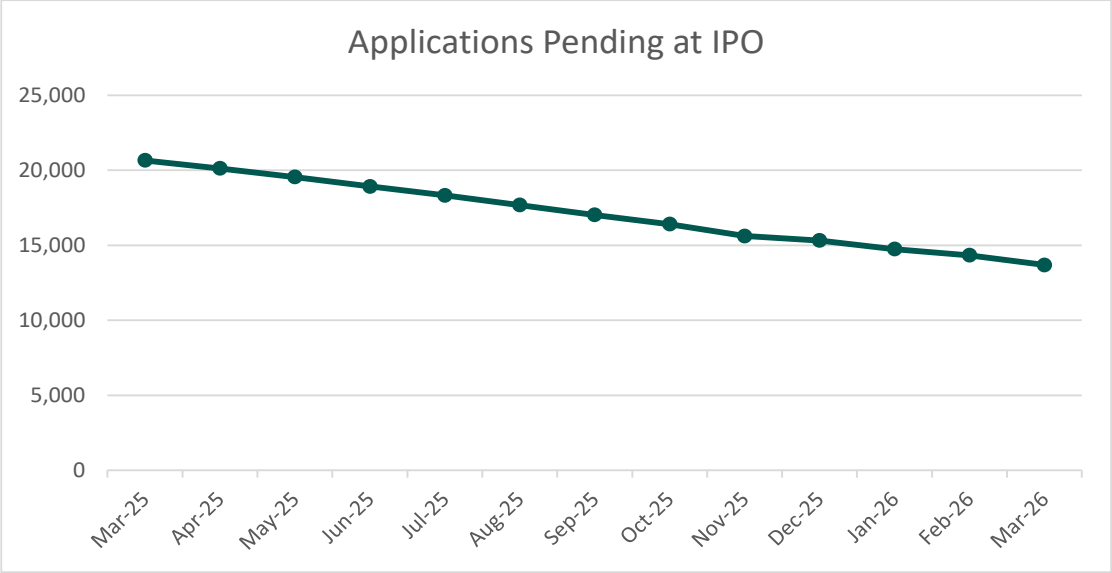
- Compared to last year, the number of asylum applications has risen slightly. In March 2026 there were 923 applications compared to 849 in March 2025
- The main countries of origin for 2026 are: Somalia (645 applications), Nigeria (423), Pakistan (330), Afghanistan (266) and Vietnam (188)
- The number of applications pending in the IPO has been reducing since the end of September 2024, when it stood at 23,863. As of March this year, there were 13,689 applications pending
- Compared to last year, there has been a slight increase in the number of applications where the IPO made a recommendation or otherwise closed off a case. In March 2026, 1,570 cases were closed off compared to 1,546 in March 2025
- The median time to make a decision for standard cases has decreased slightly. In March 2026, the median processing time to determination was 68 weeks (compared to 75 weeks in September 2025 and 75 weeks in December 2025)
- The number of staff in the IPO has decreased slightly to 613 at the end of March 2026
- Of those applications where a final decision was made in March 2026 (for example, after the outcomes of appeals were considered), 58% of decisions were refusals, 1% permission to remain, and 41% were international protection grants

Applications and Main Nationalities



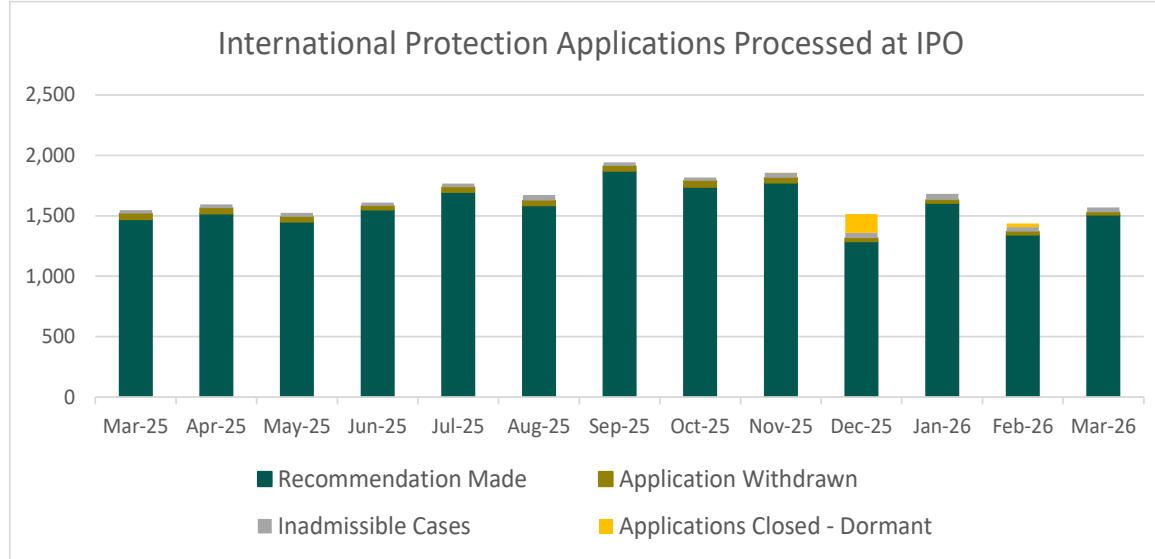
- In March 2026 there were 923 applications received for asylum. This is up from 849 last March
- The total number of applications in March 2026 that fell under accelerated procedure was 368 (which represents 40% of all applicants)
- The main countries of origin for 2026 are: Somalia (645 applications), Nigeria (423), Pakistan (330), Afghanistan (266) and Vietnam (188)

Pending International Protection Applications

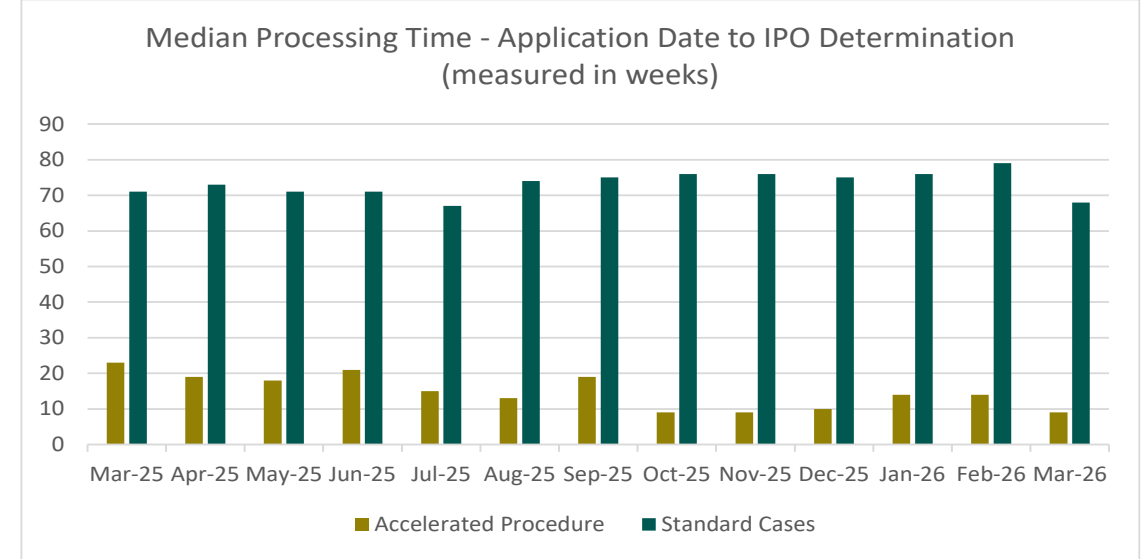


- The number of applications pending in the IPO is 13,689. The numbers have been reducing since the end of September 2024
- The number of pending applications for IPAT has been trending upwards. In March 2026, there were 19,969 applications pending
- The pending figure for MDU at the end of March 2026 is 50

International Protection: Applications Processed and Median Processing Time

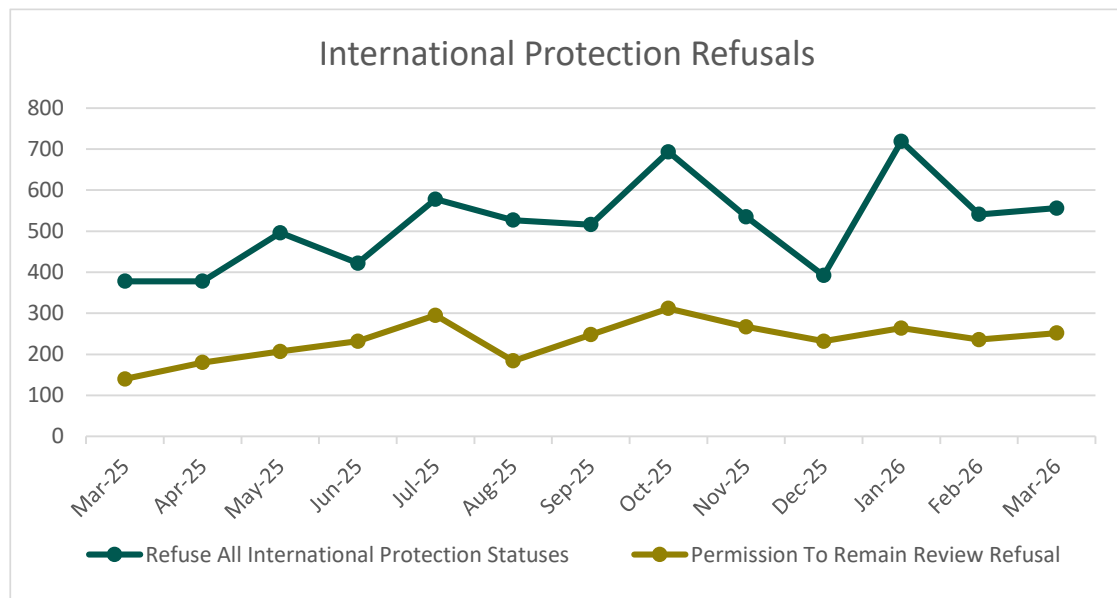
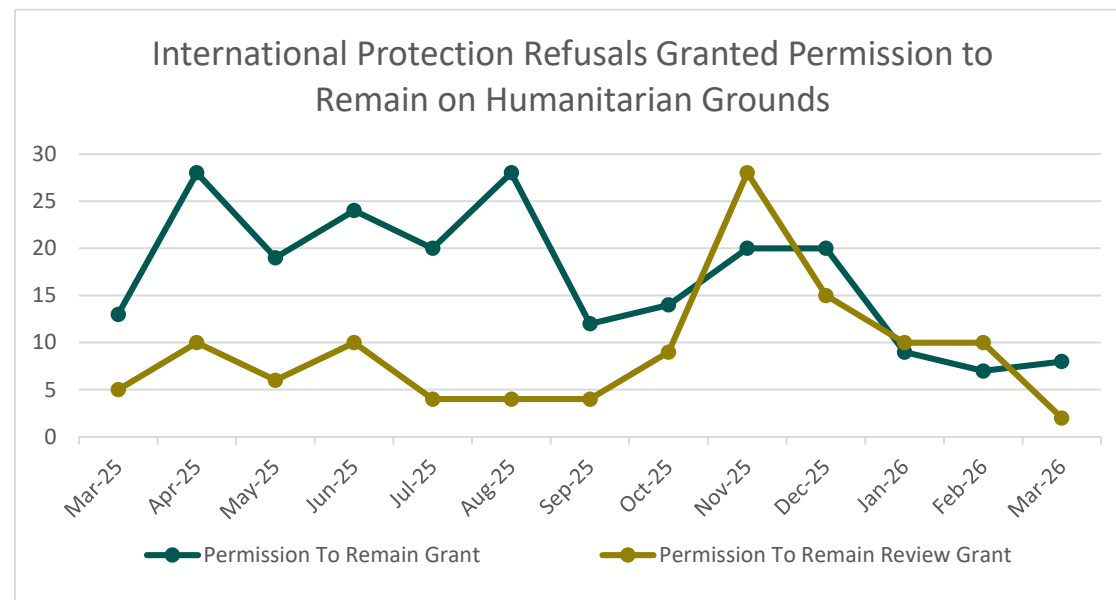
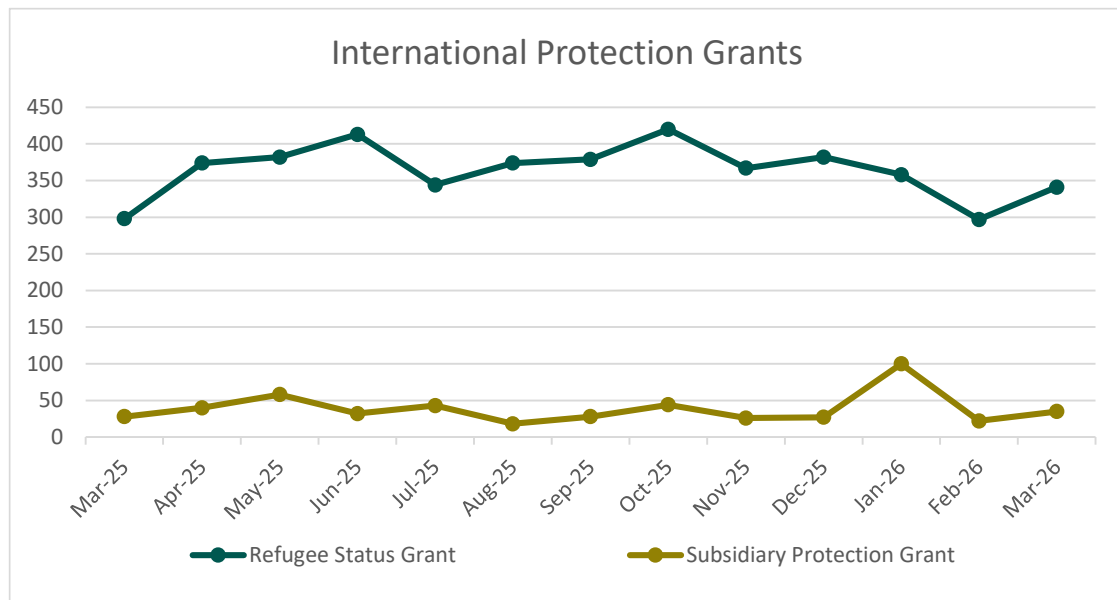


- This table is counting Recommendations Made, Applications Deemed Inadmissible, Applications Withdrawn and Dormant Applications
- In March 2026, 1,570 cases were closed off. This is down from 1,681 in January and up from 1,437 in February
- 2026 YTD applications processed were 4,688 (a 5.1% decrease on 4,942 applications processed for 2025)



- The median processing time to determining an outcome to an asylum application had been remaining steady for Standard Cases. The median processing time for cases under the Accelerated Procedure have decreased compared to the first half of 2025.
- In March 2026, the median processing time to determination for standard cases was 68 weeks (down from 75 weeks in September 2025 and 75 weeks in December 2025)
- For accelerated procedure only, the median processing time was 9 weeks in March 2026, down from 14 weeks in January and 14 weeks in February 2026

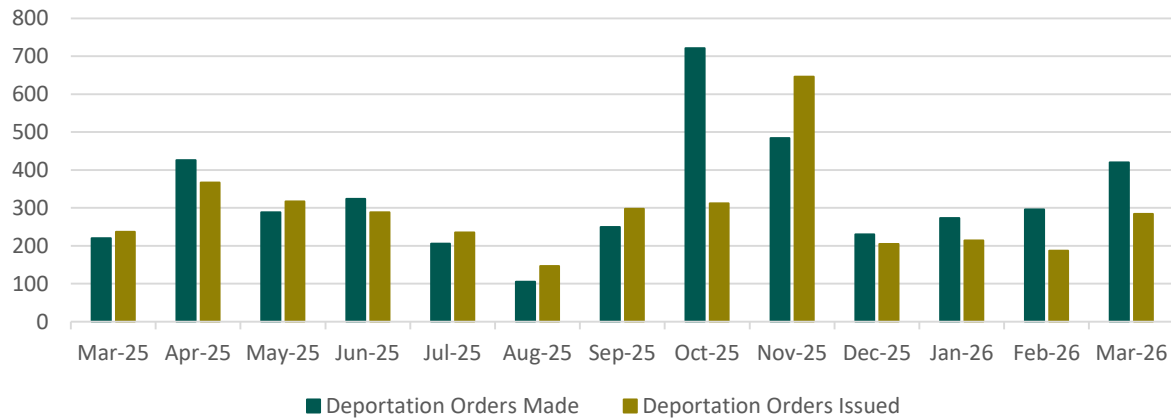
International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused



- In March 2026, of those applications where a final decision was made (for example, after taking into account appeals), 341 were given refugee status grant and 35 subsidiary protection grant (376 in total). There is significant variation in these decisions over the last few months with no clear trend
- Of those who were refused refugee status and subsidiary protection, 8 were given Permission to Remain on humanitarian grounds with 2 on a Permission to Remain Review Grant. There is significant variation in these decisions over the last few months with no clear trend
- There were 556 refusals for International Protection Statuses and 236 for Permission to Remain Review
- Overall, for March 2026, 58% of decisions were refusals, 1% permission to remain, and 41% were international protection grants

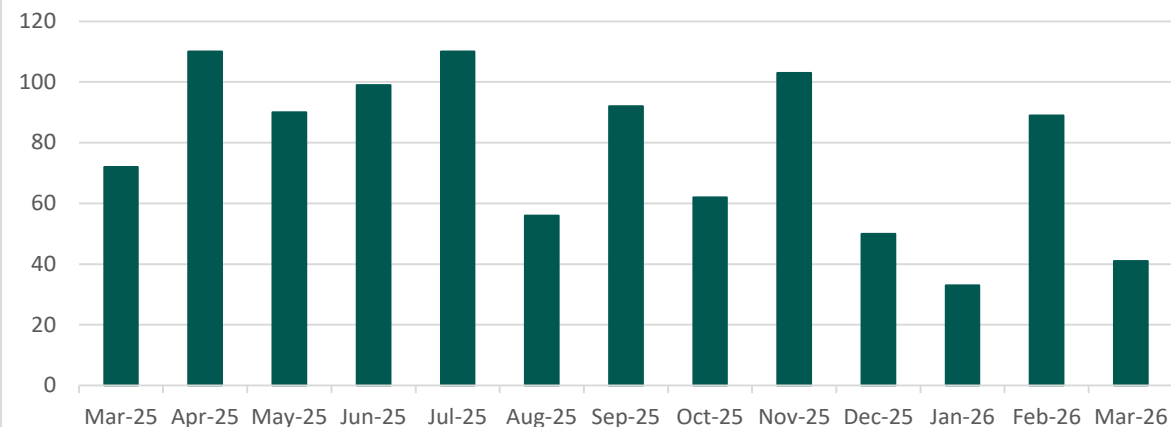
Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

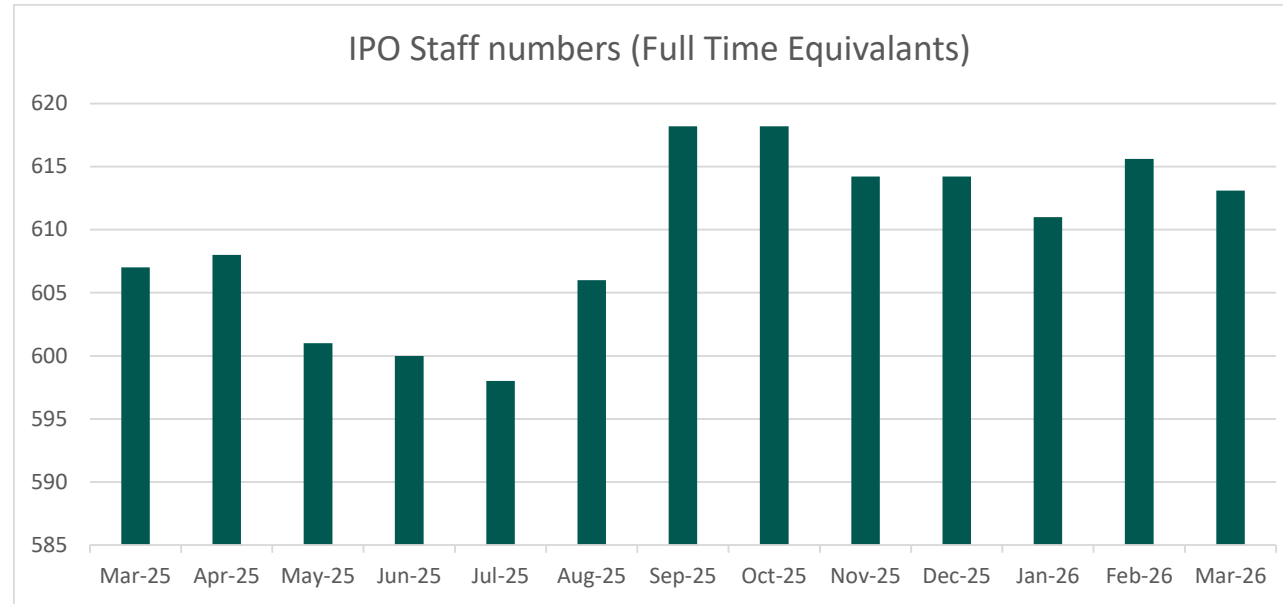


- For March 2026 the number of deportation orders made/signed (where a person had a previous asylum application) was 420 and the number of deportation orders issued was 284. For February, the figures were 296 and 187, and for January, the figures were 273 and 214, respectively
- For March 2026 the number of removals was 41

Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application



IPO Staff number (Full-Time Equivalents)



- The number of staff in the IPO has started levelling off
- In March 2025 there were 607 FTEs in IPO. This number has been generally trending upwards with some fluctuations, to 611 January and 615.6 in February 2026.
- At the end of March 2026, the IPO had 613.1 FTE staff



Appendix

Methodology

Pending International Protection Applications

- IPO – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- IPAT – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- MDU – Data sourced from AISIP. Pending figure does not include legacy cases – the legacy data has been captured in such a way that it cannot be accurately reported on

International Protection: Interviews and Applications Processed

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes

International Protection Applications Processing Times

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- Applicants to whom section 38(5) of the International Protection Act 2015 applies (failure to co-operate) are included in the calculations
- Where an interview took place after a case was reactivated the reactivation date is used as the application date, otherwise the original application date was used for the processing time calculation
- The median calculation is used for processing time at IPO as there are significant outliers in the length of time asylum applications can spend in processing. This is typically due to lengthy procedures such as judicial reviews which are complex and time consuming by their nature, and which are also outside of the remit and control of the IPO during that part of the process. The median is a more accurate measure of the time spent by the IPO in processing applications.

Methodology

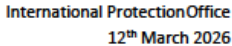
International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused

- Quashed decisions and Revocation of Status are not included
- Decision figures include international protection decisions (IPDN) and legacy application types
- Each applicant is represented once in the granted and refused tables
 - For example, if a person is refused refugee status but is granted subsidiary protection they are recorded once in the tables as a subsidiary protection grant. This is to more clearly represent the overall numbers of granted and refused applicants, and to avoid double counting of individuals where they are refused one type of status but are granted another.
- Some of the applicants who have been granted permission to remain are also included in the 'Refuse All International Protection Statuses' category of the refusals table. Permission to remain is a humanitarian permission. In order to be considered for permission to remain you must first have been refused international protection. On slide 7, the 'International Protection Refusals Granted Permission to Remain on Humanitarian Grounds' chart is a combination of applicants still in the asylum process and applicants who have finished the process. The 'International Protection Refusals' chart includes only those applicants who have finished the asylum process.
- Where a revocation occurs the original grant is removed from the figures for the month the permission was originally granted. For example, if an application was granted in January but subsequently revoked later in the year the January figure is updated to remove the grant

Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

- Data for the International Protection Deportation Order (IPDP) application type is sourced from AISIP. All other data is sourced from Lotus Notes

General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015



Data Tables (1)

International Protection Office - Applications Received

	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26
Accelerated Procedure	263	327	333	285	344	440	589	519	400	549	397	375	368
Standard Cases	586	746	608	716	821	611	739	704	694	707	726	645	555

International Protection Office – Top 5 Nationality Applications

Top 5 nationalities 2026 to date	Applications	%
Somalia	645	21.0%
Nigeria	423	13.8%
Pakistan	330	10.8%
Afghanistan	266	8.7%
Vietnam	188	6.1%
Other	1214	39.6%
Total	3066	

Data Tables (2)

International Protection Office - Pending Applications

IPO Pending	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26
IP Pending	20,655	20,122	19,551	18,922	18,323	17,676	17,021	16,402	15,620	15,315	14,741	14,332	13,689
Leg Pending	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

International Protection Appeals Tribunal - Pending Applications

	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26
IPAT Pending	11,814	12,517	13,393	14,035	14,529	15,397	16,067	16,958	17,579	18,243	19,076	19,570	19,969

Ministerial Decisions Unit - Pending Applications

MDU Pending	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26
Total	216	168	123	95	119	101	152	73	68	85	69	67	50

Data Tables (3)

International Protection Office – Processed Cases

	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26
Recommendation Made	1,471	1,520	1,451	1,551	1,697	1,587	1,873	1,739	1,774	1,288	1,606	1,345	1,510
Application Withdrawn	47	43	41	31	40	40	40	51	41	29	25	25	19
Inadmissible Cases	28	31	31	27	30	44	28	27	39	41	50	37	41
Applications Closed - Dormant	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	4	157	0	30	0

International Protection Office Median Process Time – Application Date to IPO Determination (measured in weeks)

	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26
Accelerated Procedure	23	19	18	21	15	13	19	9	9	10	14	14	9
Standard Cases	71	73	71	71	67	74	75	76	76	75	76	79	68

Data Tables (4)

International Protection Decisions – Grants

	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26
Refugee Status Grant	298	374	382	413	344	374	379	420	367	382	358	297	341
Subsidiary Protection Grant	28	40	58	32	43	18	28	44	26	27	100	22	35
Permission To Remain Grant	13	28	19	24	20	28	12	14	20	20	9	7	8
Permission To Remain Review Grant	5	10	6	10	4	4	4	9	28	15	10	10	2

International Protection Decisions – Refusals

	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26
Refuse All International Protection Statuses	378	378	496	422	578	527	516	693	535	392	719	541	556
Permission To Remain Review Refusals	140	180	207	232	295	184	248	312	267	232	264	236	252

Data Tables (5)

Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26
Deportation Orders Made	220	426	288	324	206	105	250	721	484	230	273	296	420
Deportation Orders Issued	237	367	317	288	235	147	298	312	646	205	214	187	284

Deportation Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application

Enforcements/Returns	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26
Total	72	110	90	99	110	56	92	62	103	50	33	89	41

Data Tables (6)

International Protection Office Staff Numbers (Full-Time Equivalents)

	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26
IPO Staffing Levels	607	608	601	600	598	606	618.2	618.2	614.2	614.2	611	615.6	613.1